

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E4LY04 | Year 4 | Multisyllabic Words, Figurative Language & Inference

LEARNING INTENTION
I am learning to read a passage using knowledge of multisyllabic words, figurative language and inference skills.

READING STRATEGY
Chunk multisyllabic words into parts. Look for figurative language (similes, metaphors). Use inference — what does the author imply but not directly state?

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

When European scientists first examined a platypus specimen in 1799, they suspected a hoax. Surely no creature could have a duck's bill, beaver's tail and otter's feet — all in one body! Yet the platypus is entirely genuine, and one of nature's most extraordinary animals. It is one of only five monotremes — mammals that lay eggs instead of giving birth to live young. The platypus hunts underwater with eyes and ears sealed shut, using its bill to detect electrical signals from prey. Males carry a venomous spur on their hind legs, making them one of Australia's few venomous mammals. The platypus is found only in eastern Australia and is a symbol of our unique biodiversity. Habitat loss and pollution threaten its survival in the wild.

- VOCABULARY HELPER**
- specimen = a sample of an animal used for scientific study
- monotremes = the group of mammals that lay eggs
- venomous = capable of injecting poison through a sting or bite
- biodiversity = the variety of plant and animal life in a habitat
- electrical signals = tiny electric pulses produced by living things

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ
What makes the platypus unusual compared to other mammals? Write one sentence:

- A — COMPREHENSION**
1. Why did European scientists suspect a hoax in 1799?
-
2. What is a monotreme?
-
3. How does the platypus hunt underwater?
-
4. What threatens the platypus today?
-

- B — INFERENCE AND ANALYSIS**
1. Why is the platypus described as 'one of nature's most extraordinary animals'? Use 2 examples from the text:
-
-
2. What does the author mean by 'a symbol of our unique biodiversity'?
-
-

C — WORD STUDY
Break 'biodiversity' into two parts and explain the meaning of each:

Name: _____

Date: _____

Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept prior knowledge about platypus features.

A1. Because it looked like a combination of several different animals. A2. A mammal that lays eggs. A3. With its bill detecting electrical signals from prey, eyes and ears sealed. A4. Habitat loss and pollution.

B1. Any 2: lays eggs (unusual for a mammal), detects electricity, venomous spur, three different animals' features in one. B2. Accept: It represents Australia's unique and rare animal life.

C: bio (life) + diversity (variety) = variety of life. Mono- = one; monotreme = one-holed mammal.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write a persuasive argument for why the platypus should be on Australia's coat of arms instead of the kangaroo and emu. Use 3 specific reasons.

PARENT TIP

Look up platypus facts together. Ask: 'What other unique Australian animals do you know? What makes Australian wildlife different from other countries?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to Science — adaptations. Students compare platypus adaptations to another animal. Create a class book: 'Australia's Most Unusual Animals'.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [] I can explain why the platypus is extraordinary
- [] I can break words into meaningful parts (bio-, mono-)
- [] I can use text evidence to support my ideas